PORTFOLIO PROJECT · REAL DATA: ONTARIO HEALTH, AUGUST 2026

Where do Ontario's emergency patients wait longest?

159 hospital emergency departments compared on four wait-time indicators.

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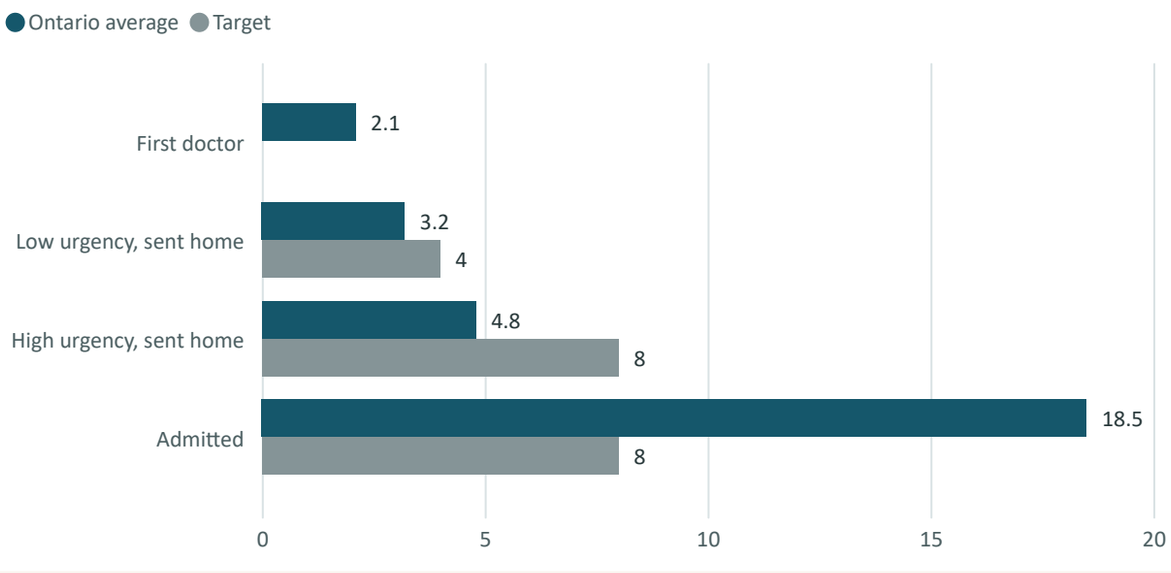
Area: All

Definitions: hours = average time a patient spends in the emergency department, from arrival until they leave or are admitted. Targets: 8 hours for admitted patients and high-urgency patients sent home, 4 hours for low-urgency patients. Area: GTA or rest of Ontario.

Admitted, Ontario	To first doctor	Median site	Sites at 24 h+	GTA median	Rest of Ontario
▲ 10.5 h over 8 h	Steady all year	Half of sites wait longer	11% of 150 sites	▲ 6.0 h vs the rest	Admitted hours
18.5 h	**2.1 h**	**13.6 h**	**16**	**17.9 h**	**11.9 h**

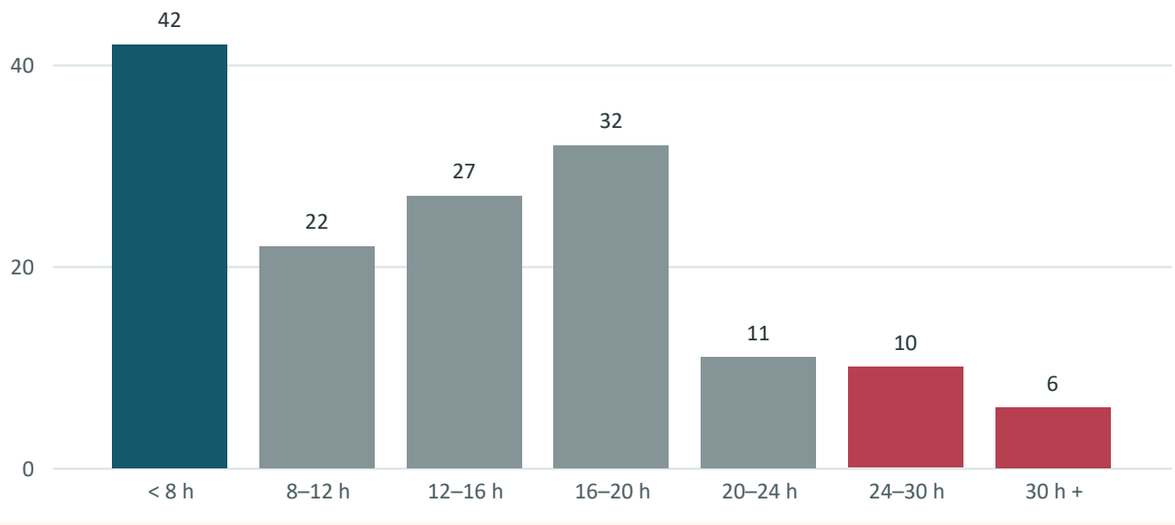
Ontario average vs target

Hours in ED by patient group. Only admitted patients are far over target.



Sites by admitted-patient time in ED

Number of hospital sites in each band. Dark blue = within target, red = a day or more.



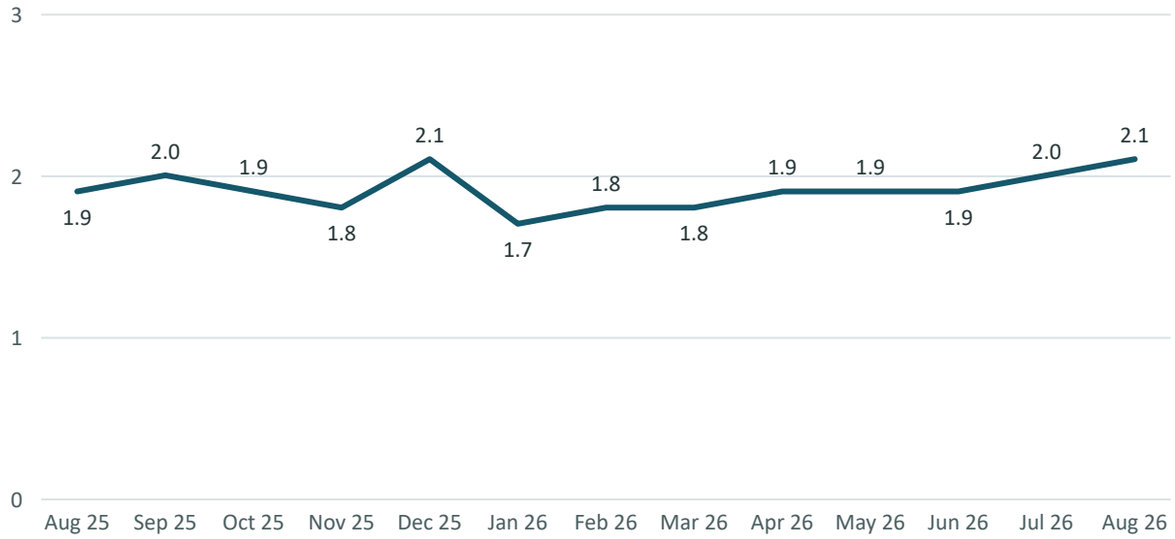
Sites ranked by admitted-patient time

Longest first. First-doctor time shows the front door is rarely the problem.

Rank	Hospital	Area	Admitted h	First doctor h
15	Rural Road Health Services-Tillsonburg	Rest of Onta…	24.3	2.1
15	Southlake Regional Health Centre	GTA	24.3	0.5
17	Georgian Bay General Hosp-Midland Site	Rest of Onta…	23.6	2.5
17	Hamilton Health Sciences Corp-General	Rest of Onta…	23.6	2.6
19	Scarborough Health Network-Birchmount S…	GTA	23.1	1.4
20	Niagara Health System-St Catharines Gen	Rest of Onta…	22.9	2.5
21	Trillium Health Partners-Mississauga	GTA	22.0	1.4
22	Unity Health Toronto - St. Joseph's	GTA	21.4	1.1
			14.4	**1.9**

Time to first doctor, Ontario

Monthly provincial average, Aug 2025 to Aug 2026. Stable all year.



What this means

1. The bottleneck is inpatient flow, not the ED front door. Time to first doctor barely predicts admitted wait (r = 0.29). Track admitted-patient time as a hospital-wide KPI alongside discharges and ALC days.

2. Pair the slowest sites with peers that hit target. Large GTA community hospitals dominate the slowest list; compare bed-management practice with similar-sized sites within target.

3. Caveats. One month; site averages are unweighted by volume; GTA grouping is my own; small sites do not report admitted patients.

Data: Ontario Health, Time Spent in Emergency Departments (public), August 2026 · Analysis and report design: Vatsal Patel

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